Getting the right people in a single room (physical or virtual) and dropping on their laps the question “What is your domain?” or “What is your business area about?” is usually counterproductive. People don’t know what you don’t know. They will try to avoid stating the obvious (to them), or might get bored and impatient, not seeing how they can benefit from what they’ll perceive as going in circles. This is why we advise using workshop techniques to facilitate that discussion.

4.1.3 Choose the correct workshop technique

Multiple techniques can be used to capture business knowledge, but we highly recommend the method that arose inside the DDD community: *domain storytelling*. This method can be handy because it was designed with domain thinking in mind. It can provide well-established heuristics for extracting domains and subdomains. Moreover, this technique is lightweight and well described in easily accessible open source materials. Also, the method is inclusive, meaning that participants are actively collaborating during sessions.

Other domain-capturing techniques

We also recommend two other domain-capturing techniques: rich pictures and event storming. *Event storming*, invented by Alberto Brandolini, is one of the most well-known facilitation techniques in the DDD community. You can use it as a replacement for domain storytelling. Event storming can help you achieve a common understanding of the domain you are responsible for and data use cases that you should solve or help with.

This method works best in a face-to-face environment because of its inherently dynamic nature. Its power comes from discussions of spontaneously forming subgroups. Unfortunately, simulating such group dynamics in a virtual meeting is difficult. If you want to learn more, *Introducing EventStorming* (by Brandolini) is the right book for you; at the time of writing, the book is a draft available on Leanpub.

The *rich pictures* technique, developed as part of Peter Checkland’s soft systems methodology (SSM), is straightforward and isn’t focused on any formal notation. Instead, this technique is a way to discover, define, or capture an idea in the form of diagrams. The outcome of this exercise is an initial mental model. This model can depict various things: a process, the